

A Day in Salvador

Salvador offers so much in a relatively small space – vibrant culture, fascinating history, and a string of lovely ocean and bay beaches.

MORNING Begin a wander through Salvador history on the **Terreiro de Jesus**, a square in the heart of the old city surrounded by a cluster of the best Baroque buildings in Brazil. These include the **Igreja e Convento do Sao Francisco**, whose interior is covered in almost a ton of gold. Afterward pay a visit to **MAfro**, the African museum also on the square, then have lunch in **Axego**.

AFTERNOON Wander downhill from Axego past the pastel-painted houses to **Pelourinho** for the best pictures of the colonial center. Visit the old African church of **Nossa Senhora do Rosário dos Pretos** at the foot of the main square, built by slaves in their precious free time during the late 18th century. Then take a taxi to the **Mercado Modelo**, a big open market crammed with souvenirs.

EVENING Take a taxi along the beaches, stopping off at **Barra** for a juice and finishing in **Rio Vermelho** for *acarajé* and local nightlife.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Domestic and international airlines fly into Bahia's Salvador **airport**; there are **buses** and **taxis** to the historic center.

WHERE TO STAY

Albergue Hostel São Jorge (inexpensive) has backpacker bargain rooms in the heart of the historic center. www.saojorgehostel.com
Pousada do Boqueirão (moderate) offers boutique comfort in a renovated colonial building with wonderful views over the Bay of All Saints. www.pousadaboqueirao.com.br
Pestana Convento do Carmo (expensive) is Salvador's grandest hotel, housed in a converted Baroque convent in the picturesque district of Pelourinho. www.pestana.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.bahiatursa.ba.gov.br



Right A *baiana de acarajé* in traditional white clothing, with a necklace in the colors of her personal *orixa* (deity)

Below The main square in Pelourinho, the 16th-century heart of Salvador

